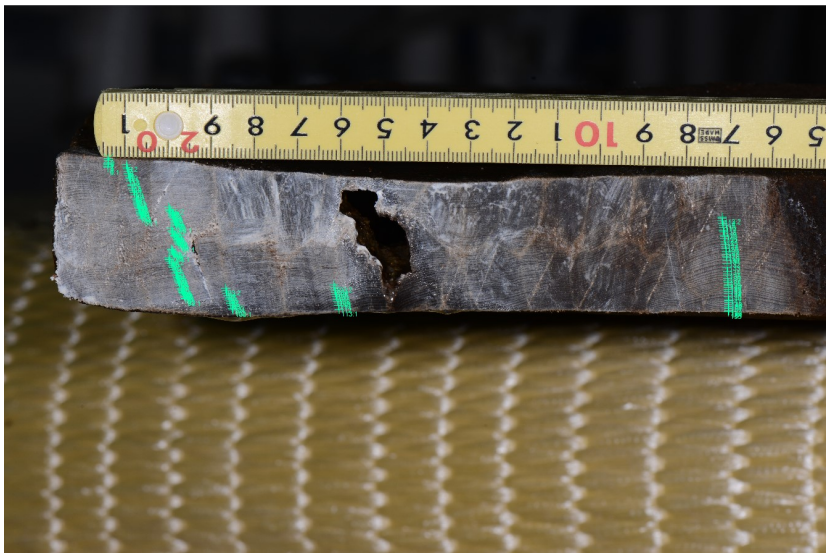
Lesson 5 Trace evidence through a specimen ID

About eight minutes, replacing one case-reading activity. Use the printed evidence below; web exploration can wait until revision.



Nabunken specimen 29ho018. Green marks are published measurement locations. The entire image, including ruler and annotations, is retained.

Nara National Research Institute for Cultural Properties, 2024. CC BY 4.0.

Field	Information in the public record
ID and object	29ho018: lower well-frame board A1, well SE9650
Species	Hinoki cypress (Chamaecyparis obtusa)
Images	YH1_9812.JPG; annotated YH1_9812_29ho018.jpg
Width series	29ho018.csv: 155 rings, inner to outer, in 0.01 mm
First three values	32, 44, 42 = 0.32, 0.44, 0.42 mm
Not supplied in this CSV	Calendar years, reference chronology, match statistics, felling date

Connect the ID, image and width series. Correct the claim that 155 rings means the timber is 155 years old. What additional record is needed to assess its dating?

Nabunken 29ho018, CC BY 4.0

Lesson 5 Public data and the basis of interpretation

Check

155 is the number of measured rings, not elapsed years before the present. The CSV has no calendar-year column. Images and widths support checking the measurements. Assessing the date also requires the reference chronology, overlap, match results and their evaluation.

Follow the dataset description, metadata, specimen image and CSV, then the relevant dendrochronology section of Monograph 103. Record the reported date, outermost condition and basis of crossdating. Mark an unlocated item as unverified rather than filling it by inference.

Claim	Additional evidence
Calendar year of each ring	Reference series, candidate alignments, overlap, visual and statistical checks
Felling date	Bark edge, sapwood and wood lost through working
Construction and use of the well	Excavation context, stratigraphy, other finds and reuse traces

If 29ho017 is used for comparison, does a separate board necessarily represent a separate tree?

Different boards could come from one tree. Different IDs alone do not establish biological independence.

Dataset entry

Nabunken Monograph 103: excavation report